

The *ReNo* Methodology

A multi-axis framework for measuring personality structure and tracking it over time — translating it into developmental and vocational guidance for adults and for children.

Instrument: ReNo — five-axis personality model

Products: PsyID (adult, 15–45) · PsyID Youth (children 8–14)

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00 About this document

This whitepaper defines the ReNo instrument: its theoretical foundations, its five measurement axes, its scoring and coding system, the shadow/growth-edge it derives, its profile architecture, and the empirical roadmap required to validate it.

It is a **methodology document**, not marketing material. It describes what ReNo measures and why, in terms a psychometrician or research collaborator would expect. The consumer-facing translation of these constructs — the warm, parent-facing language, the animal totems, the campaign copy — is deliberately kept in a separate layer and is out of scope here.

HONEST STATUS

ReNo is at present a **theoretically specified but empirically unvalidated** instrument. The constructs, axes, and scoring logic are defined here; reliability, factor structure, and population norms are *roadmap items*, not accomplished facts. Nothing here should be presented to customers or investors as a validated psychometric result until the development study in Section 10 is complete.

Contents

1	Purpose & scope	—
2	Theoretical foundations (incl. attribution & IP)	—
3	The three-level architecture	—
4	The five axes	—
5	Scoring & the intensity code	—
6	Construct hygiene: what was separated	—
7	Type-naming architecture	—
8	The shadow / growth edge	—
9	The profile & the passport	—
10	Measurement development (the DeVellis path)	—
11	The stability hypothesis & longitudinal design	—
12	Validation & publication roadmap	—
13	Ethics, framing & data separation	—
Appendix	Code reference	—

01 Purpose & scope

ReNo measures the stable structure of an individual's personality, tracks how it consolidates over time, and translates that structure into guidance about fit — educational, vocational, and developmental.

The instrument powers two products that share one engine but must never be conflated:

PsyID — adult (15-45)

Self-report. English-language. Targets people *figuring out their lives* — career fit, identity, decisions at a crossroads. There is no upper age limit; older adults are welcome, but the product is built for those actively working out direction. Delivered as tiered reports.

PsyID Youth — children (8-14)

Parent-observed. Russian-language. A “psychological passport” the parent completes, yielding developmental guidance and profession directions.

WHY THE YOUTH FLOOR IS 8, NOT 6

Before roughly age 7-8 a child's personality is still highly malleable and its structure is not yet reliably measurable — early-childhood temperament is real but under-differentiated, and self- or parent-report at that age carries too much noise. The working theory is that as the brain matures, a measurable, increasingly stable core emerges. ReNo therefore begins at **8**, where the constructs are crystallized enough to measure, and treats the 8-14 window as a *consolidating* profile rather than a fixed one (Section 11). At **15**, the person transitions to the adult self-report instrument — a clean hand-off from parent-observed to self-observed.

THE PASSPORT IS LONGITUDINAL BY DESIGN

Both products produce a **passport** — not a one-off result but a dated record the user builds up over repeated tests, so they can see their own personality history across years. This is a core feature, not an add-on: it is what turns a quiz into a developmental record, and it is the same mechanism that makes the stability study (Section 11) possible.

ReNo carries a dual mandate. Commercially, it produces reports and a passport people will pay to maintain. Scientifically, it is designed from day one to collect the item-level, timestamped, repeatable data needed to test a genuine question about personality stability and development.

02 Theoretical foundations

ReNo is not a single-theory instrument. It draws several established traditions into one architecture, using McAdams' model of personality as the integrating spine.

Tradition	What it contributes	Role in ReNo
Jung — <i>Psychological Types</i> (1921)	The attitude-types (introversion/extraversion), the four functions, and the <i>inferior function</i> & shadow.	Origin of Axes 1–3 and of the shadow (Section 8).
Lawrence — <i>People Types & Tiger Stripes</i>	Type applied to learning; persona/shadow; lifelong <i>type development</i> .	Grounds the shadow/growth-edge and the develops-over-time claim.
Holland — RIASEC	Six vocational-interest types.	The bridge from measured traits to profession fit (Level 2).
Deci & Ryan — Self-Determination Theory	Three basic needs: autonomy, competence, relatedness.	The motivational layer of guidance.
Murray — <i>Explorations in Personality</i>	Personology: internal <i>needs</i> x environmental <i>press</i> .	Frames guidance as person x environment fit.
McAdams — three-level model	Traits, characteristic adaptations, narrative identity.	The integrating architecture (Section 3).

ON DRAWING ON THESE THEORIES — ATTRIBUTION & IP

Building a new instrument inspired by these thinkers is **standard, legitimate scholarship**, and naming them is the correct move. Scientific ideas and theories are not copyrightable — the concept of introversion, the RIASEC types, the three-level model are ideas, free to build on — and citation is what distinguishes theory-building from plagiarism. It is required for publication and it builds authority for the product. Two lines not to cross: (1) do not reproduce others' *copyrighted expression* — their exact descriptions, item wording, tables (ReNo paraphrases and rebuilds throughout); (2) do not use *trademarks in branding* — MBTI®, Myers-Briggs®, the branded 16-type names, Holland's Self-Directed Search® — or imply their validation transfers to ReNo. The renaming in Section 4 exists precisely to stay clear of this line. *This is general information, not legal advice; a short IP review before commercial launch is advisable.*

A deliberate gap: ReNo's trait layer overlaps the **Big Five**, but ReNo is not a Big Five instrument. The Big Five is the external yardstick against which ReNo's axes will be validated (Section 12), not a component of the model.

03 The three-level architecture

Every ReNo profile is organized on McAdams' three levels. This governs what each part of a profile is permitted to claim.

Level	What it is	ReNo component	Product tier
Level 1 Dispositional traits	Broad, decontextualized, relatively stable tendencies. “The psychology of the stranger.”	The five measured axes.	Tier 1 — “Who am I?”
Level 2 Characteristic adaptations	Goals, motives, interests, coping — contextualized in role and time.	RIASEC mapping; SDT needs; profession directions; the growth edge.	Tier 2 — “Where do I fit?”
Level 3 Narrative identity	The internalized, evolving life story that gives a life unity and purpose.	The archetype / totem and its story framing.	Tier 3 — “What do I do next?”

THE RULE THIS ENFORCES

A **measurement claim** (Level 1) and a **story** (Level 3) are different kinds of statement. The axis scores may be defended as data; the archetype is explicitly a narrative and is never presented as a measured result. Keeping the levels distinct is what keeps ReNo honest as it scales from a quiz into a research instrument.

04 The five axes

ReNo measures five orthogonal axes. Each is a spectrum scored 0–100, not a category. Axis 5 (Emotional Response) exists partly to clean contamination out of Axes 3 and 4 (Section 6).

#	Dimension	Poles (code)	Construct	Lineage & boundary
1	Energy Orientation <i>внимание</i>	Outward O Inward W	Direction attention and energy habitually flow — outer world of people/action vs inner world of concept/reflection.	Jung's attitude-types. Not sociability or social skill.
2	Information Focus <i>восприятие мира</i>	Concrete C Abstract A	Which information is trusted first — concrete fact/detail vs pattern/meaning/possibility.	Jung's sensation/intuition; bridges to RIASEC. Not intelligence or thoroughness.
3	Decision Basis <i>принятие решений</i>	Logic L Values V	The criterion decisions rest on — impersonal analysis vs person-centred values.	Jung's thinking/feeling. Not composure under pressure (→ Axis 5).
4	Structure Preference <i>организация жизни</i>	Ordered D Flexible F	How the outer world and time are managed — planning/order/closure vs spontaneity/flexibility.	Myers' extension; ≈ Conscientiousness. Not steadiness, risk, or novelty-seeking.
5	Emotional Response <i>new in v1</i>	Steady S Reactive R	Baseline emotional tempo — even-keeled and slow to rattle vs quickly and deeply affected.	Big Five Emotional Stability. Not clinical — normal-range temperament only.

NAMING DISCIPLINE

Axes are named by the *dimension*, not a pole, so a 0–100 score reads as a position on a spectrum. Pole letters are language-neutral and visually distinct (**O** / **W** avoid “I reads as one” and the E-collision; **D** = or**D**ered). The system abandons all MBTI and socionics vocabulary (Логик/Этик, Рационал/Иррационал) — both to avoid others' IP and to resolve a collision: Jung uses “rational” to mean *judging*, which the old labels contradicted.

05 Scoring & the intensity code

Each axis produces a continuous 0–100 score, banded into five intensity levels per pole for reading, and expressed as a compact code — but the raw score is always the record.

Band digit	Raw score	Original label	Reading
5	81–100	Максимальный	Maximal — the trait dominates behaviour
4	61–80	Сильный	Strong — clearly, consistently expressed
3	41–60	Выраженный	Pronounced — present, situational
2	21–40	Умеренный	Moderate — a mild lean
1	1–20	Слабый	Slight — barely distinguishable from balanced
0	~50 / balanced	Амбиверт	Balanced — no meaningful lean

A full ReNo signature is five slots — pole letter plus band digit — joined by separators:

W2 ▪ A4 ▪ V3 ▪ F4 ▪ S2

This is richer than a four-letter type: **03** and **05** are distinguishable, so year-over-year comparison happens on a graded scale rather than a flip/no-flip binary. It is also fully language-neutral — identical for an English adult and a Russian parent; only the archetype on top is localized.

NON-NEGOTIABLE PRINCIPLE

The raw 0–100 score is the record; the band and code are only a display layer.

Every reliability calculation, stability comparison, and published analysis runs on the continuous score. Bands *communicate*; they never *compute*. Running analysis on bands would manufacture false instability wherever a score sits near a band edge (60 vs 61).

06 Construct hygiene: what was separated

The original rubric measured behaviour richly but let distinct constructs bleed across axes. An axis carrying two constructs cannot factor cleanly, and cross-loading items are the main reason scores drift year to year for reasons that are not real change. v1 performs a deliberate separation.

Descriptor in the old rubric	Was attached to	Action in v1
"Stays composed while others lose control"	Axis 3 — Decision Basis	→ Move to Axis 5 . Stress tolerance, not decision logic.
"Emotional stability"	Axis 4 — Structure	→ Move to Axis 5 . Never a structure construct.
"Mood swings drive productivity"	Axis 4 — Structure	→ Move to Axis 5 . Emotional tempo.
Risk propensity	Axis 4 — Structure	→ Drop as a direct measure. A blend of low-Conscientiousness, low-Neuroticism, high-Extraversion — cross-loads on three axes. Let it emerge, don't measure it.
Conservative vs innovator	Axis 4 — Structure	→ Fold into Axis 2 . Openness-to-novelty is the same signal as Concrete↔Abstract.

After this pass, **Axis 4 measures only order-vs-spontaneity and starter-vs-finisher** — clean Conscientiousness — and the emotional content now lives, cleanly, on Axis 5. This is the version that survives factor analysis and gives a trustworthy longitudinal read.

07 Type-naming architecture

The user never remembers five axes. They remember one name. The code is the engine; the name is the dashboard. The two products use different naming skins over the same code spine.

Youth — animal totems

job: reassurance + pride

A parent remembers “my daughter is a Fox.” The animal is the System 1 hook; the methodology sits below the fold for the involved parent.

Adult — archetype roles

job: self-understanding + decisions

“The Steady Builder,” “The Quick Improviser.” A named role reads as insight and carries authority; an adult told they’re an “Owl” feels infantilized.

Three rules that hold the system together

- **Shared invisible spine.** The five-axis code is identical across both products — what makes them one family, not two quizzes.
- **The name is a mapping, not a spelling.** Do not force the axis letters to spell a word; a name is a label bolted onto a *region* of the code space, as “The Architect” is bolted onto a coordinate.
- **Name off the dominant, high-band axis.** A near-balanced profile (band 0–1) gets a distinct “adaptable / versatile” name rather than being jammed into a strong pole.

THE CROSS-SELL BRIDGE

Each child animal maps to its adult archetype on the *same axis-pole* (child “Fox” → adult “Improviser”). This pairing is the literal mechanism of cross-selling: a parent already committed to the framework for their child converts more readily on themselves (Cialdini's commitment & consistency).

Axis 5 is excluded from the headline name. No child is “The Reactive One.” And any animal set must be sense-checked for connotation in the *target* culture — symbolism is not universal — so the Russian totems require validation against Russian associations, not English.

08 The shadow / growth edge

Every profile has a front and a back. The dominant preferences are the front — the persona a person leads with. The shadow is the back: the underdeveloped opposite poles, and especially the least-developed axis, where a person operates less consciously and less skillfully. ReNo surfaces this as the **growth edge**.

Where it comes from

- **Jung** — the *shadow* (the unconscious, unexpressed side of the personality) and, in type terms, the *inferior function* (the least-differentiated function, which operates in a primitive, often disruptive way outside conscious control).
- **Lawrence, *People Types & Tiger Stripes*** — treats persona and shadow explicitly: the persona is the side one shows the world; the shadow is its back side, away from public exposure. Lawrence frames *type development* as the lifelong work of developing the less-preferred sides.

IT IS DERIVED, NOT A SIXTH AXIS

The shadow is **computed from the existing five axes** — the opposite pole of each dominant preference, weighted toward the least-developed axis (the one closest to balanced, or lowest-band among the leading functions). It is an *interpretation* — a Level 2/3 output — never a measurement. It gets no code slot and no confidence band of its own.

Why it is the reason to re-test

This is where the stability picture becomes both subtle and more accurate. Jung's claim is not that a person never changes — it is that the **core preferences are stable while the shadow / inferior functions develop over the lifespan** (individuation; Lawrence's “type development”). The structure holds; the shadow grows. That resolves the apparent paradox of a longitudinal product: if personality were fully fixed, why re-test? Because the passport tracks *two* things at once — the stable core (which should hold) and the developing growth edge (which should move). The re-test is not looking for the core to change; it is watching the shadow mature.

FRAMING RULE — THIS ONE IS SENSITIVE

For adults, “shadow / untapped potential / where you get in your own way” is a compelling hook. For a **child's profile shown to a parent, “shadow” and “not living up to potential” must never read as a deficit or a dark verdict on the child**. The parent-facing frame is strengths-based and developmental — “growth edge,” “emerging strengths,” “where your child will benefit from support” — grounded in SDT (empower the parent's competence to develop the weaker side), never a label. Same construct, life-stage-appropriate language, exactly as with Axis 5.

09 The profile & the passport

A worked example, showing how one code expands into the three levels — and how the passport records it over time.

W2 ■ A4 ■ V3 ■ F4 ■ S2

Axis	Raw (0–100)	Band	Code	Reading
Energy Orientation	32 — Inward	2	W2	Mildly inward; recharges alone, warms up in small groups
Information Focus	71 — Abstract	4	A4	Strongly abstract; drawn to ideas, patterns, “what if”
Decision Basis	54 — Values	3	V3	Pronounced values-led; weighs people and fairness first
Structure Preference	68 — Flexible	4	F4	Strongly flexible; improvises, resists rigid schedules
Emotional Response	38 — Steady-ish	2	S2	Fairly steady; occasional sensitivity under real stress

Growth edge (derived): the least-developed axis here is Energy Orientation (W2, near-balanced) — the shadow points toward developing outward expression: speaking up, initiating. Framed for a parent as “where a little encouragement pays off,” not a weakness.

What the three levels contain

- **Level 1 — measured.** The five axes as spectrum positions, each with a *confidence band* not a false-precision point (“71, likely 64–78”). Visualized as a radar. The band protects the retest promise — next year’s 66 shown as movement *within* the band reads as stability, not “your child changed.”
- **Level 2 — interpretive.** The code translated into patterns: RIASEC direction and profession fit from the *code-to-RIASEC mapping*, SDT motivational profile, and the growth edge (Section 8).
- **Level 3 — narrative.** The archetype/totem and a short life-story framing — the part a person screenshots. Explicitly a story.

The passport

Each test writes a dated entry to the user's passport. Over years, the passport shows two trend-lines: the **stable core** (dominant axes, expected to hold within their confidence bands) and the **growth edge** (expected to develop). For the youth product it states plainly that it is based on parent observation, which sets up the annual re-test naturally.

10 Measurement development — the DeVellis path

To move ReNo from “specified” to “validated,” it follows the standard scale-development sequence (DeVellis, *Scale Development*).

1. **Define each construct.** Done — Section 4, with explicit “not-this” boundaries.
2. **Generate a broad item pool.** ~15–20 candidate items per axis, deliberately redundant, so weak items drop and a reliable ~10-item scale remains.
3. **Fix the response format.** Likert agreement, continuous scoring behind the bands.
4. **Expert review** for content validity — the role for the credentialed collaborator.
5. **Include validation items** (Section 12) so convergent validity is tested in the same sitting.
6. **Administer to a development sample.** The launch itself is a viable first data-collection engine.
7. **Item & factor analysis** — confirm five clean factors; drop cross-loading items.
8. **Optimize scale length** — reliability vs brevity.

Item design rules

- **One construct per item** — the point of Section 6.
- **Balanced reverse-scoring** so acquiescence bias does not inflate a pole.
- **Behaviourally anchored** — an observable action, never a trait word. Parents rate behaviour accurately but infer traits poorly.
- **Two phrasings** — adult self-report, and parent-observer for the 8–14 youth version.

Form	Scores toward	Item (Axis 1, Energy Orientation)
Adult	Outward	“After a long social event I feel energized rather than drained.”
Adult (reverse)	Inward	“I need time alone to recharge after being around people.”
Parent-observer	Outward	“After a big group activity my child is wound-up and lively rather than tired and quiet.”
Parent-observer (reverse)	Inward	“My child retreats to a quiet activity to recover after lots of social time.”

11 The stability hypothesis & longitudinal design

ReNo's guiding question: does personality structure stabilize as the brain matures, and how much? Users re-test over time and profiles are compared. This section states honestly what the literature supports and what the design must do to yield a real finding rather than an artifact.

What the evidence actually shows

- **A measurable core emerges in middle childhood.** This is the empirical basis for the age-8 floor: below ~7-8 the Big Five structure is under-differentiated and unreliable to measure; by 8 it is crystallized enough to assess. So the “stabilizes as the brain develops” theory is directionally supported.
- **Rank-order stability rises with age but is not yet high in the 8-14 window.** Consistency climbs through childhood and adolescence and only plateaus near age 50 (Roberts & DelVecchio). The honest framing is “an increasingly stable core,” not a “fixed” result at 8 — which is exactly why the 8-14 profile is treated as consolidating and tracked, not stamped.
- **Mean-level maturation happens even in stable people** (the maturity principle): normative drift toward more conscientiousness, agreeableness, emotional stability. Rank can hold while absolute scores move.
- **The core holds while the shadow develops** (Section 8) — the developmental claim ReNo actually makes, and the reason re-testing is meaningful rather than redundant.

THE DESIGN TRAP — AND WHY CONTINUOUS SCORING IS THE FIX

A categorical type re-tested annually **manufactures** instability: a person near a cut-point flips on trivial fluctuation. ReNo measures stability on the **continuous 0-100 axes**, never bands or type — which requires knowing **test-retest reliability first**, because without it true change cannot be separated from measurement error. That separation is the entire study.

Design requirements

- Store and analyze **raw continuous scores** with item-level responses and timestamps, from launch.
- Establish **test-retest reliability** (short interval) before interpreting long-interval change.
- Report **rank-order**, **mean-level**, and **profile** stability separately.
- Model change by **age band**, expecting genuinely lower stability across 8-14.

Designed this way, the passport is a legitimate longitudinal panel, and the commercial funnel doubles as the data engine for a real, publishable question.

12 Validation & publication roadmap

To claim validity, ReNo axes must correlate with established instruments (convergent) and behave distinctly where they should (discriminant).

Instrument	Validates	Use
NEO-PI-R	Full Big Five, facet-level	Gold-standard convergent check for Axes 2, 4, 5 (and Extraversion vs Axis 1)
TIPi	Big Five, brief	Low-friction embed in the post-purchase flow
Holland RIASEC inventory	Vocational interests	Validates the Level-2 profession mapping
Basic Psychological Needs Scale	SDT needs	Validates the motivational layer
MMTIC	Child type measurement	Closest existing benchmark for the youth instrument

The publication pathway depends on one operational fact: **item-level, timestamped response data must be collected from day one**. Research consent and follow-up items are embedded in the post-purchase flow at launch, so the dataset for a validation-and-stability paper accumulates as a by-product of ordinary sales.

13 Ethics, framing & data separation

A personality product aimed at children carries responsibilities a career quiz does not.

- **Adult and youth data are physically separated** and never aggregated in any view or analysis.
- **Normal-range only.** Axis 5 measures temperament, not pathology. The words *neurotic*, *unstable*, *anxious* never appear. The strengths-based frame is **Sensitive ↔ Steady** (cf. Aron's highly-sensitive-child work) — accurate, not spin.
- **The shadow is framed as a growth edge, never a deficit** — especially for a child. No profile tells a parent their child has a “dark side”; it shows where support helps (SDT competence).
- **Empower the parent, do not diagnose the child.** Guidance is “how to support a child like this,” never a verdict.
- **Transparency.** The youth report states it is based on parent observation; the methodology is available to the high-involvement parent (ELM).
- **Consent for research** is explicit, separate, and revocable — opt-in, never a condition of purchase.

A Appendix — code reference

Axis	Pole	Pole
1 — Energy Orientation	O — Outward	W — Inward
2 — Information Focus	C — Concrete	A — Abstract
3 — Decision Basis	L — Logic	V — Values
4 — Structure Preference	D — Ordered	F — Flexible
5 — Emotional Response	S — Steady	R — Reactive

Format: `[pole letter][band digit]` per axis, fixed order 1-5, separated by middots. Band digit 0 = balanced. The shadow/growth edge is derived from these five, not coded separately.

ONE-LINE SUMMARY OF THE WHOLE MODEL

Five clean axes, scored continuously, banded for reading, expressed as one language-neutral code, named by a single dominant-axis totem or archetype, with a derived shadow/growth-edge — the stable core reserved for the science, the story reserved for the person, and both tracked over time in the passport.

ReNo Methodology v1.1 — working draft, July 2026. Constructs and architecture specified; empirical validation pending per Sections 10-12. Prepared for internal use and research-collaborator review. Consumer-facing language is developed separately and is out of scope.